

Introduction

The ACME Spy Agency has been recruiting lately, posting ads in newspapers and on the internet.

On a whim you decided to send in an application. Today a letter arrived in the mail.

[illegible]

Location, location, location

The ACME company has sent a limousine to bring you to their headquarters. The driver seems to be a rather chatty chap and after telling you all about his past as a spy and how important it is to always know your location, he asks if you are up for a game to pass the time. Suspecting this might be one of the tests for the job you applied for, you agree. He describes locations and you have to guess what they are.



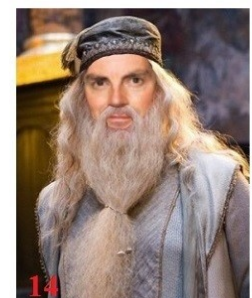
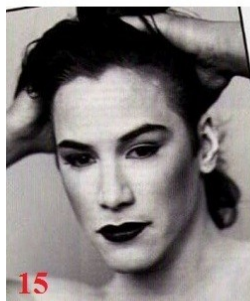
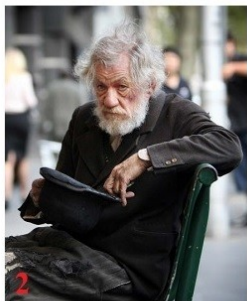
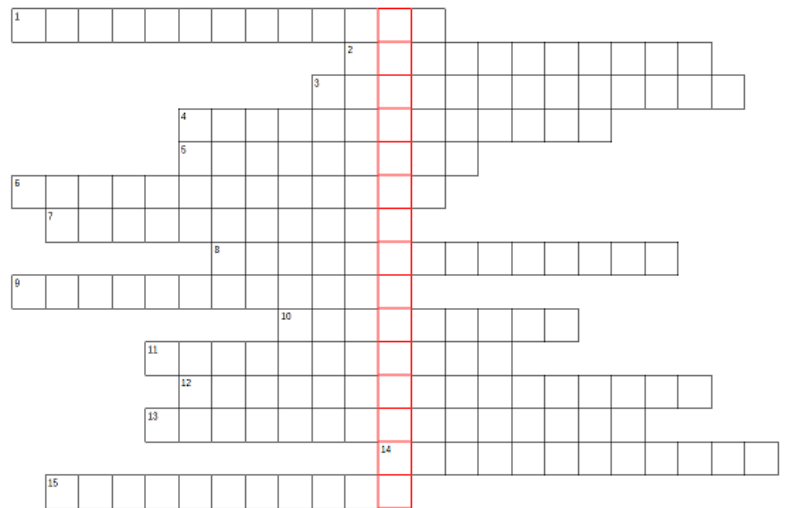
1. My hats with skills are scary
2. I'm soulful and invest in popping
3. He supplants me, unreturned and convoluted
4. She swipes the dwarves I filled
5. In advance, we partnered with bids
6. No weeks to brave the cove
7. I straddled the sprayer for sponsors
8. The castaway is latest to events
9. On bikes, an audio is half
10. The chair is topical for regime
11. A banker with rigs has lump
12. Not exactly, it's previous in boatyard

Master of disguise

After a long drive through the countryside you have been dropped off at a large Victorian mansion. You walk up to the entrance door, but before you get a chance to ring the bell, the door is opened by a butler who looks a lot like Lurch from the Addams family.

“Welcome,” he says. “We have been expecting you. Please follow me to the waiting room.”

The waiting room turns out to be more of a lounge, with nice comfy chairs and sofas. There is also coffee, tea and cake. To your surprise there are already quite a few people there, who look strangely familiar.

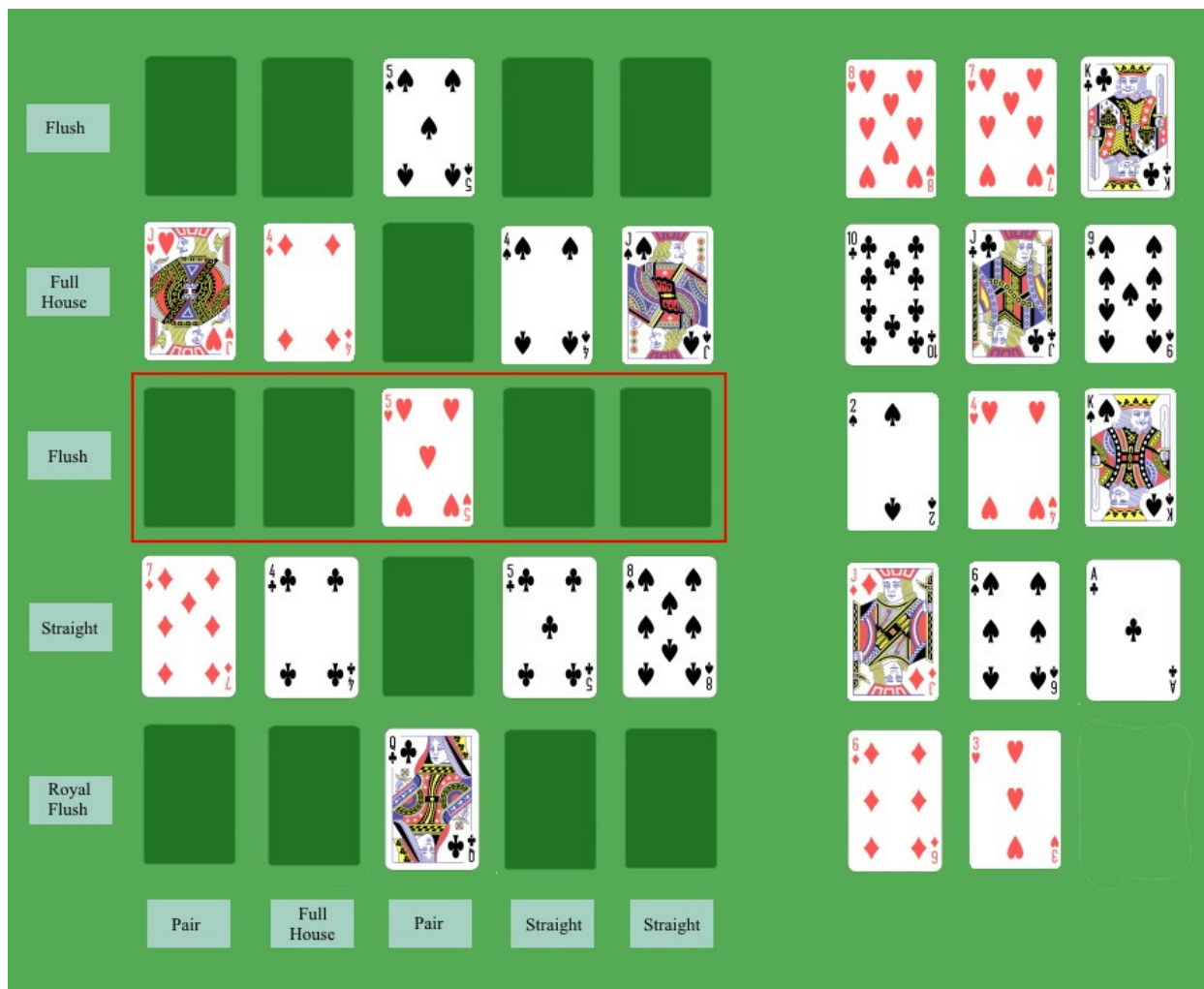


All bets are off

You've almost finished your second slice of cake, when the butler makes an announcement.

“Ladies and Gentlemen, the wait is over. Let the games begin.”

He opens a door to a lavishly decorated room that is setup as a full-blown casino. There are two roulette tables, a craps table and several places to play card games like blackjack and poker. Maybe you should try one of those.



Too many locks, not enough keys

You have been playing for a while when the butler discreetly taps your shoulder.

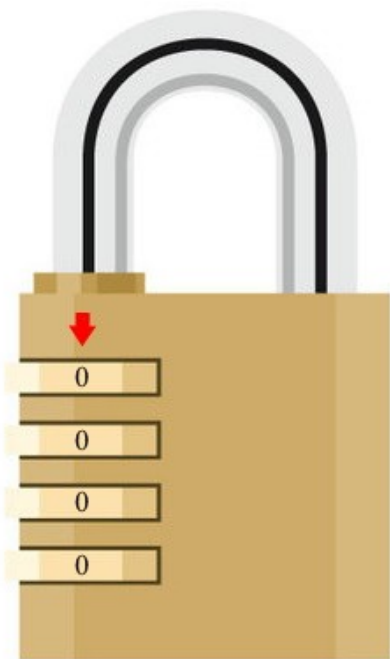
“It's time for the next test,” he says, “Please, follow me outside.”

Once you're outside in the garden he pulls out a blindfold and proceeds to tie it over your eyes, explaining that it is part of the test. He then leads you along a path full of twists and turns.

“We have arrived at the destination,” he says, “Please, sit down. You can remove the blindfold when you have counted to twenty.”

You dutifully count to twenty, while you hear him leave. When you remove the blindfold you see that you are in a gazebo which seems to be located in the middle of some sort of hedge maze. When you try to stand up however, you notice that you have been handcuffed to the iron garden bench you are sitting on. Maybe you shouldn't have been so trusting, although it's probably just part of the test.

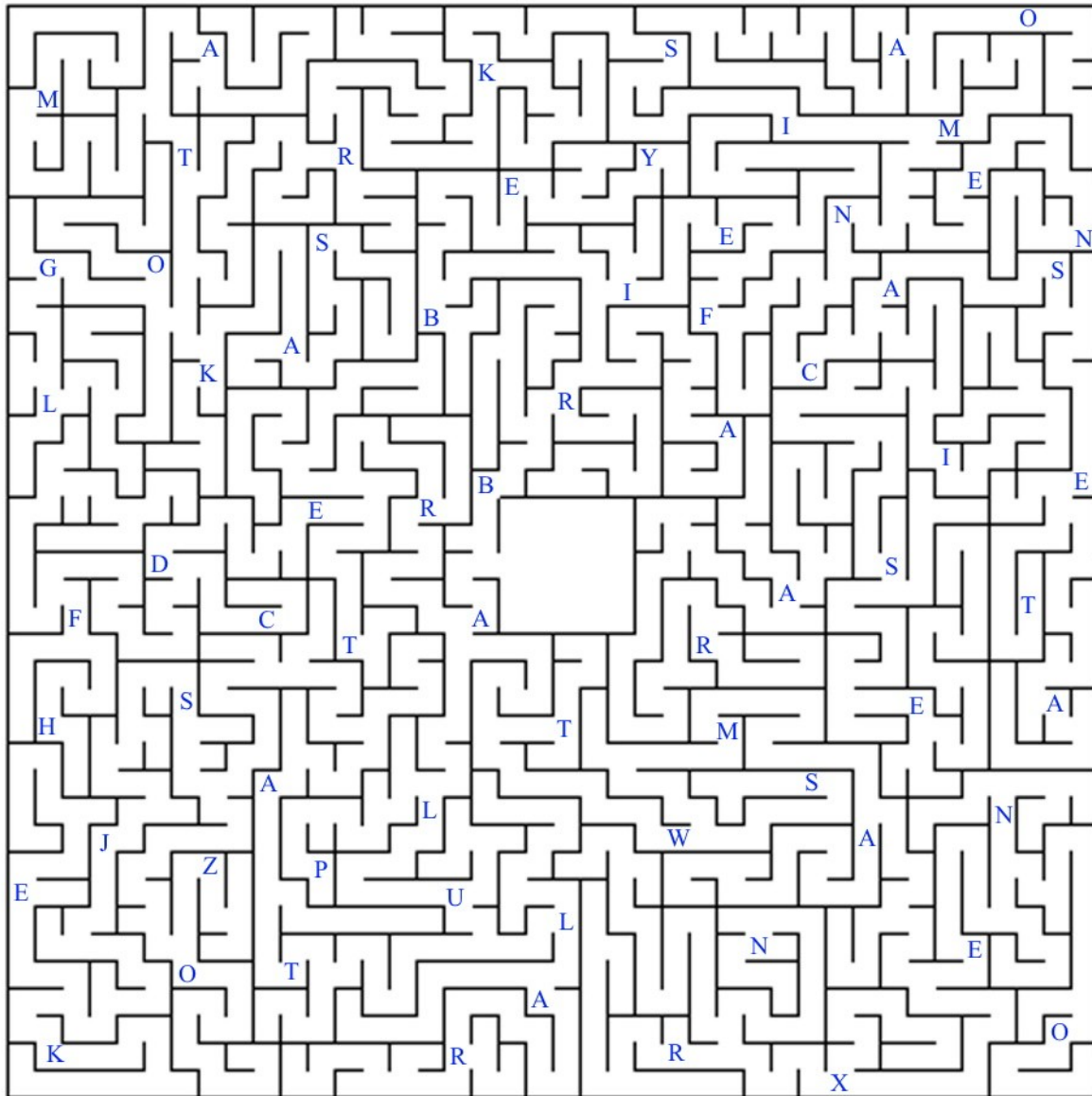
The handcuffs are locked with a combination lock, so you try to find some obvious hints for the code, but you don't see any. There is however a small locked viking chest right next to you on the bench. That can't be a coincidence. You unsuccessfully try to open the chest, when you suddenly notice that there are some markings carved into the bottom of it. You hope it won't require a mastermind to decipher them.



Get out

You remove the handcuffs. It's good to feel free again.

Now, how to get out of the maze? The hedges consist of prickly thorn bushes, so it's probably not a good idea to go straight through them. It might be best to just follow the paths and try to remember what turns were taken on the way in.



Lock, stock and barrel

As you exit the maze, who else but your old friend the butler is there waiting for you.

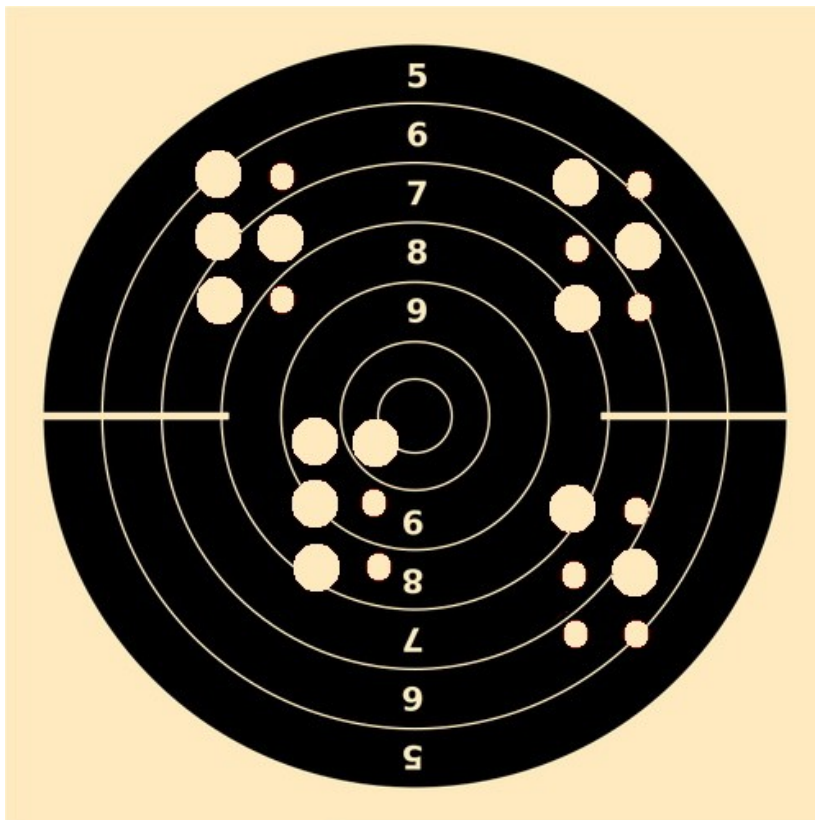
“Well done. There seems to be nothing wrong with your orientation skills.”

“Next up ... the gun range, for some shooting practice.”

The butler escorts you to a gun range and introduces you to the range master, who explains the safety rules to you. The first exercise is outdoors, shooting some clay pigeons. After that you get to try out some different guns and rifles in an indoor facility.

The range master is looking closely at your target scorecards, murmuring, “Not bad. Not bad at all.”

He then goes to a filing cabinet, opens a drawer and pulls out another scorecard. He says “This is Miss Jones's scorecard from this morning. Her shooting was a bit wayward today. Maybe her rifle needs checking – there might be something wrong with her sight.” He hands Miss Jones's scorecard to you. “As you might know, Miss Jones is our human resource manager and our main recruiter. She told me to give this to you when you finished your shooting. I have a feeling it is important.”



Research and destroy

“Oh,” the range master continues, “I almost forgot to tell you. Miss Jones is expecting you in the library. Down the hallway. Third door to the left.”.

When you enter the library a tall woman wearing a black dress, a pearl necklace and dark rimmed glasses comes towards you.

“Good afternoon. Nice to finally meet you. As you've probably already guessed I'm Miss Jones. I have had some pretty favourable reports about your test results.”

She gives you three pieces of paper.

“Here are the next test problems. They are all related to the most important part of being a spy; finding and interpreting information. I'm sorry I can't stay here to give any more information, but I have some urgent matters to attend to. I will be back in about an hour.”

Miss Jones leaves the library, leaving you on your own. You look around. The walls are stacked with books on all kinds of subjects, from Sun Tzu's “The Art of War” to manuals about beekeeping. There is also a desk with a computer showing the Google homepage, probably more your style of finding out information. Well, enough looking around. Time to start on the tests.

Find and eliminate the Bond villains.

A	G	N	A	M	A	R	A	C	S	O	C	S	I	C	N	A	R	F
E	B	O	J	D	D	O	R	E	V	R	A	C	T	O	I	L	L	E
R	E	A	A	R	I	S	K	R	I	S	T	A	T	O	S	R	R	A
N	W	E	N	E	P	L	O	V	A	N	O	I	F	F	T	E	D	I
S	H	R	H	A	I	F	A	T	P	S	E	E	R	S	D	G	O	D
T	O	E	E	E	Y	L	T	A	R	R	A	A	U	G	A	N	T	E
S	N	L	G	K	E	L	R	N	F	U	N	N	R	M	K	I	D	M
T	S	E	N	I	A	T	E	F	U	Z	K	A	D	A	N	F	O	A
A	U	K	A	O	S	T	I	V	S	B	N	H	M	O	I	D	M	S
V	I	T	H	K	E	H	I	A	E	T	A	A	I	K	R	L	I	N
R	L	R	C	N	C	T	N	H	X	R	L	M	C	N	O	O	N	O
O	U	A	T	E	O	C	I	A	W	K	T	A	R	R	Z	G	I	R
B	J	K	L	T	H	H	R	H	H	D	N	C	E	I	X	C	C	A
L	R	I	E	E	N	D	Y	A	W	K	A	N	E	P	A	I	G	B
O	D	N	Z	E	O	A	N	U	C	R	Z	R	Z	L	M	R	R	R
F	Z	G	D	G	D	L	E	I	I	O	M	S	B	C	A	U	E	A
E	A	Y	U	Y	A	G	N	A	N	A	K	R	D	M	E	A	E	U
L	R	H	A	R	G	U	S	T	A	V	G	R	A	V	E	S	N	N
D	E	M	I	L	I	O	L	A	R	G	O	A	D	R	A	N	E	R

Alec Trevelyan

Aris Kristatos

Auric Goldfinger

Baron Samedi

Brad Whitaker

Braun

Chang

Dominic Greene

Dr Julius No

Dr Kananga

Dryden

Elektra King

Elliot Carver

Emilio Largo

Ernst Stavro Blofeld

Fiona Volpe

Francisco Scaramanga

Franz Sanchez

Gustav Graves

Hai Fat

Hugo Drax

Irma Bunt

Jack Strap

Jaws

Kamal Khan

Le Chiffre

Lorenzo

Magda

Max Zorin

Mayday

Mr White

Nick Nack

Oddjob

Red Grant

Renard

Sandor

Teehee

Trukhin

Spot the spy

You've finished one of the problems, on to the next. It seems to be some kind of logical puzzle.

There are four people living in an apartment building. You have limited information about them (age and time they eat breakfast and dinner), but you know one of them is a spy. Identify the spy and their characteristics, using the information provided.

		Apartment				Age				Breakfast AM				Dinner PM			
		1	2	3	4	21	22	23	24	6	7	8	9	6	7	8	9
Name	Alice																
	Bob																
	Carol																
	Dave																
Dinner PM	6																
	7																
	8																
	9																
Breakfast AM	6																
	7																
	8																
	9																
Age	21																
	22																
	23																
	24																

- * Bob is the last to eat both breakfast and dinner
- * The two oldest people are the first to eat dinner
- * Carol is older than Alice, but younger than Dave
- * Breakfast is eaten first in the even-numbered apartments
- * The 24-year old is the first to eat both breakfast and dinner
- * Alice and Dave live in even-numbered apartments
- * The 22-year and 23-year old live in odd-numbered apartments
- * In apartment #4 breakfast is eaten at 7 AM.
- * Bob lives in an apartment with a higher number than Dave
- * The spy eats dinner 11 hours after eating breakfast.

The spy eats breakfast at —

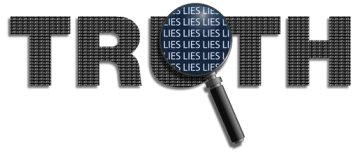
The spy eats dinner at —

The spy lives in apartment # —

The age of the spy is —

Truth and lies

Looks like the third problem is a logical puzzle as well.



As a spy you must be able to determine when people are lying and when they are speaking the truth.

There are seven people who each made a couple of statements. Samuel always tells the truth, his statements are straightforward. For the others the truth can be spotty.

Can you identify which statements are true and which are false?

- | | |
|--------|--|
| Danny | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Helen's third statement is true2. Tom's first statement is true3. Anne tells no lies4. Doug tells no lies |
| Anne | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Owen tells at least one lie2. Helen tells exactly two lies3. Doug tells at least one lie |
| Samuel | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Tom always lies2. Danny alternates between truths and lies |
| Helen | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Owen's second statement is true2. A well known code is named after Samuel3. Doug alternates between lies and truths4. Owen's third statement is true |
| Doug | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Helen's second statement is a lie2. Helen's first statement is a lie |
| Owen | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Doug's first statement is true2. All my statements are true3. Helen's fourth statement is true |
| Tom | <ol style="list-style-type: none">1. Helen tells three lies and one truth2. Owen tells two truths and one lie3. Danny's first statement is a lie |

Laser hallway

You've just finished the last problem and are wondering how long you will have to wait for Miss Jones to return, when she comes rushing in.

“Sorry, I didn't expect you to be that fast.”

You realize that you must have been on camera the whole time. Not that surprising for a spy company.

Miss Jones quickly browses through your test answers.

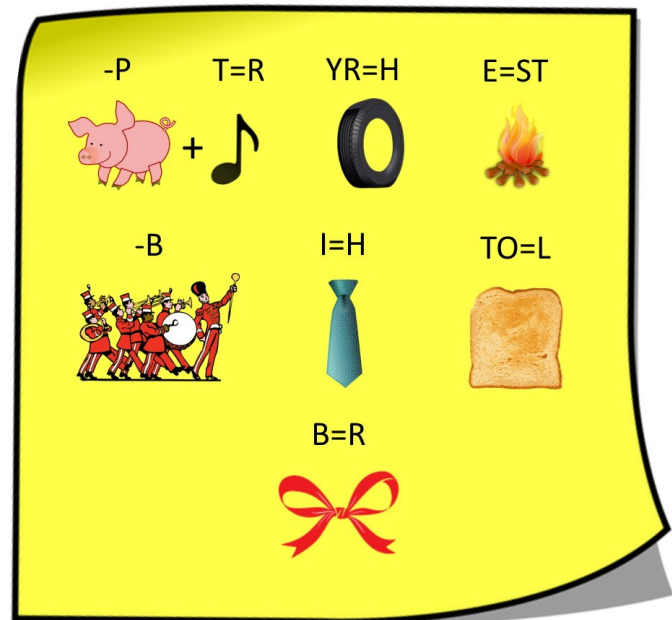
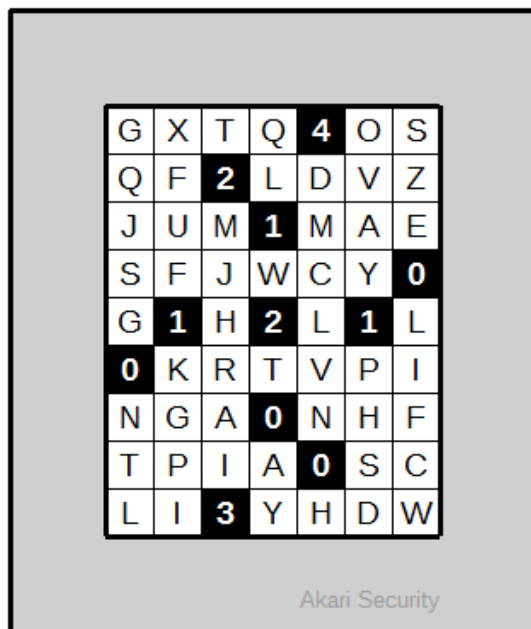
“Looks good to me. I think you are ready for the final test.”

She walks to a wall and pulls a large book from one of the shelves. The whole bookcase starts to turn and a dimly lit hallway is revealed behind it.

“For the last test you have to cross this hallway undetected, crack the safe you will find at the far end and solve the problem you will find in there. You can't see it, but the hallway is equipped with laser sensors that detect any motion. There is a panel at the beginning of the hallway where you can disable the lasers, but make sure you press the right buttons, because otherwise an alarm will go off as well.”

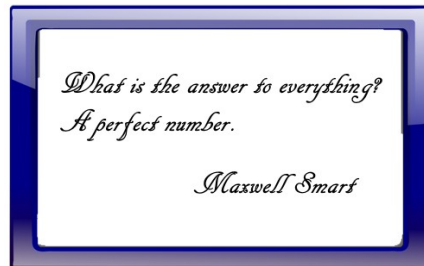
“Good luck!”

You walk up to the panel and notice someone has stuck a post-it note on it.

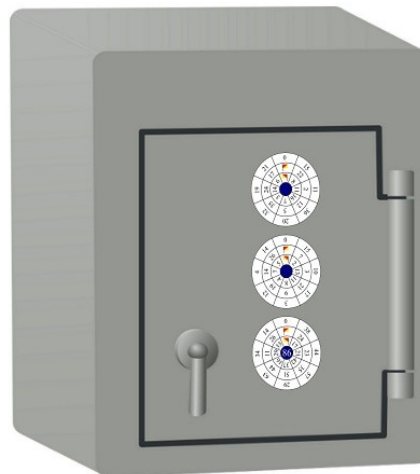
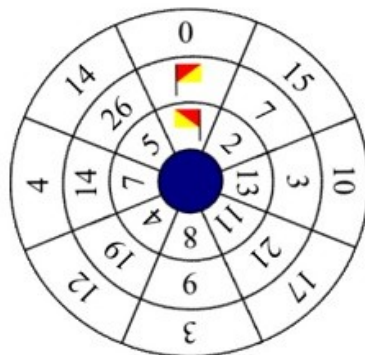
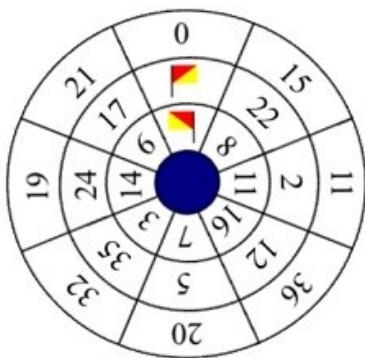


Crack the safe

You walk through the hallway, confident that you have disabled the security system. You try to spot the lasers, but don't see any. Maybe there really aren't any and it was all just smoke and mirrors. You arrive at the end of the hallway. The wall is decorated with a framed quote.



The safe you are looking for is a lot smaller than you expected. The safe has three dials, each consisting of a fixed outer ring and two inner rings that can be rotated.



Finale

You open the door of the safe and pick up the document that contains the final test. Use all the tools you have collected.

